SPACE COMBAT

The spacelanes can be dangerous. Pirates lurk near gas giants and jump points. Vessels belonging to enemy interstellar polities might raid a system and prey on the player characters' ship. The player characters might decide to engage in some piracy themselves, or they may be the crew of a patrol frigate that has found some pirates or raiders. Use the following rules to run the combat action on such occasions.

SPACE COMBAT BASICS

Ships typically fight at a range of several thousand, or tens of thousands, kilometers. However, Cepheus Deluxe abstracts ranges in ship combat. There is no need to track ranges, though creative Referees and players might describe their maneuverings and tactics in terms of range.

Space combat typically occurs in 6-minute rounds. This time accounts for weapon recharge cycles and long-range missile travel, as well as emergency repairs. Since range is abstracted using the Position mechanic (below), it is possible to run space combats at different time frames. This allows for furious dogfights between fighters, intense chases as smugglers attempt to run blockades, as well as nail-bitingly slow cat-and-mouse actions between pirates and patrol frigates, all using the same basic rules.

However long a round is in space combat, in each round every crew member may take one action, as detailed below. This means that crew members staffing two posts – such as a pilot also serving as a captain – must choose only one post they are filling in each round. This is the main reason most larger ships, and all military vessels, have dedicated captain and specialized personnel for each crew position. A character may occupy two positions at once, but in each given round, they may only act in one position. For example, smaller civilian starships often have the pilot double as the captain. In such cases, the character must choose every round if they take a piloting action or a captain's command action.

POSITION

There is no initiative or range to track in space combat. Each space combat round, all participating ships' pilots throw 1D + Piloting skill + DEX DM + their ship's current maneuver drive thrust number. The attribute DM used in space combat is usually DEX, but in some circumstances the Referee might call for INT or EDU DMs to be used instead.

The result of the 1D + Attribute DM + Pilot Skill + Maneuver Drive Thrust number is called the Position.

The ships in a space battle can only attack those targets in equal or lower Position to themselves, without restrictions. A ship with better Position may choose when to take its turn – before or after its opponents. All characters on a ship act on its turn. They can attack with any weapon on board their vessel, using the following modifiers based on the relative Position between attacker and target.

Ships with lower Positions suffers DM-3 to attack anyone with a higher Position number than them, in a given round. This penalty applies to turrets and bays. Weapons in fixed mounts or Main Guns cannot attack without Position. However, a successful Attack Vector Pilot action will allow for ships with fixed mounts or Main Guns to attack, albeit at DM-3. Note that two vessels that have the same result for their Position throw can still attack each other with all weapons, albeit at DM-2 to their attack throws.

Position Attack DM Table

Attacker is	DM to Attack Throws
Inferior Position with Main Guns or Fixed Mounts	No attack possible
Inferior Position with Turrets	DM-3
Inferior Position with Main Guns or Fixed Mounts and successful Attack Vector action	DM-3
In the same Position as the target	DM-2
1 or 2 Positions higher than the target	DM-1
3 or 4 Positions higher than the target	DM 0
5 or more Positions higher than the target	DM+1

Vessels with disabled Maneuver drives automatically lose Position. Note that space stations with a thrust of 0 roll Position normally. They simply do not have a bonus from maneuver drives. Instead of Piloting, station commanders throw 1D + Tactics + INT DM for Position. It is difficult, but not impossible, to stay in the blind spot of a station-mounted turret.

It is possible to have multiple ships engaged in combat. Simply record the different Position results in descending order. The ships higher on the "Position ladder" have better Position on any ship below them.

ACTIONS

Each character may act once in each combat round. There are five positions aboard a ship: Captain, Pilot, Sensor Operator, Gunner, and Engineer, each with its own actions. There may be only one character performing an action at a given station, with the exception of Gunners: there is one gunner per turret, bay, or main weapon on a ship. Other characters can assist one of the positions in performing their actions below, according to the rule for collaborating on skill throws found in the Basic Rules chapter.

CAPTAIN ACTIONS

The ship's captain may engage in one of the following actions:

Lead Crew: Throw Leadership/INT 8+. If successful, gain a pool of positive DM points equal to the Effect (minimum 1) that the captain may distribute towards individual throws as they see fit for the next round. For example, a result of 12 generates a pool of 4 points, which can modify one dice throw at DM+4, or modify four separate dice throws at DM+1 each.

Outmaneuver: the captain throws Tactics/INT 10+. If successful, apply a DM+2 to the ship's next round's Position throw.

PILOT ACTIONS

The pilot may take one of the following actions, in addition to the free Position throw they make at the start of each round.

Attack Vector: the pilot may throw Piloting/DEX 8+ and apply the Effect to a single weapon's attack throws for the round. This throw is not modified by the ship's thrust rating. If the Effect of the throw is 1 or greater, the pilot may distribute the Effect "points" as positive DMs to various weapons. Alternatively, if the ship does not have Position, this action allows firing fixed weapons or Main Guns at the enemy, albeit at DM-3 to hit. In this case, no positive DMs can be distributed to fixed guns.

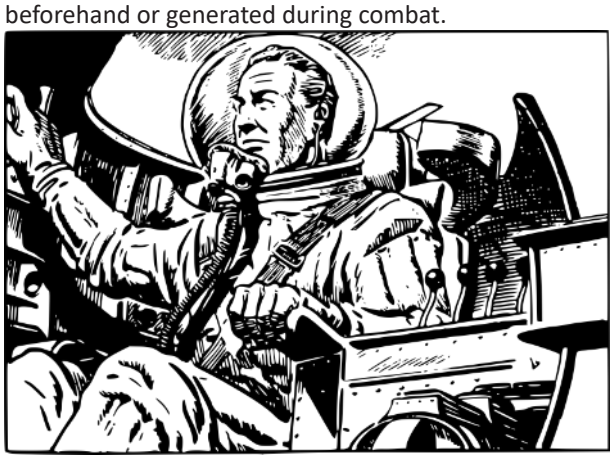
Dock: Docking is only possible with a friendly ship, or with an enemy ship without a functional maneuver drive. You may not dock with an actively maneuvering enemy ship.

Disengage: To disengage from ship combat, a ship can use their Pilot action that round to throw a Piloting/DEX opposed skill throw vs. the pursuer's Pilot/DEX, adding each ship's thrust rating to their respective throws. Whoever has Position gains Advantage on the roll for that round. The quarry escapes immediately if it wins the opposed throw. In a situation where a ship is attempting to escape multiple targets, use the Pilot skill and thrust rating from the fastest ship of the pursuing side against the lowest thrust rating of the target. Alternatively, a jump-capable ship may jump out of combat, as described below.

Evasive Maneuvers: the pilot throws Piloting/DEX 12+, modified by the ship's available maneuver drive thrust rating. On a success, apply a negative DM equal to the Pilot's skill (to a maximum of DM-3) to all incoming attacks. This does not require Position, and lasts until the start of the ship's next turn.

Plot Jump: Plotting a jump requires the pilot's attention for 6 – (Pilot Skill) space combat rounds. As well, the pilot must succeed at a Piloting/EDU 6+ throw, with a negative DM equal to the distance in parsecs. It is also possible to plot a jump in one round, but this raises the difficulty to Piloting/EDU 10+. A failed throw means that the jump must be plotted again.

Emergency Jump: throw Piloting/INT 6+ to initiate an emergency jump while under fire; if successful, the ship's engineer must throw Engineering/INT 8+ to power the jump. Failures may be re-rolled in the next round. See the Ship Operations chapter above for the jump procedure itself. Note this applies DM-2 to the Jump Throw, increasing the chance of misjump. This requires a jump plot, as noted above – either prepared beforehand or generated during combat.



SENSOR OPERATOR ACTIONS

The ship's sensor operator may act as follows:

Spoof Missiles: Electronic warfare can defeat incoming missiles; throw Computer/INT 8+, modified by the ship's Sensor DM, to spoof an incoming missile due to impact that round, or the next round. The sensor operator must roll to successfully spoof each missile. Multiple missiles may be spoofed each round up to the Sensor Operators Computer skill (minimum of 1 attempt).

Jam Sensors: Electronic warfare can provide "cover" to a ship. Roll Opposed Computer/EDU against one enemy vessel, modified by the ships' Computer DMs. If successful, the target of the Jamming suffers a negative DM to any attack roll made against the jamming ship. The negative DM is equal to the skill level of the Sensor Operator. This action is cumulative with a pilot's Evasive Maneuver action.

Scan: throw Computer/EDU 8+ to detect vessels and other objects; this throw is modified by the ship's sensor DM and by the target's stealth, if any.

Target Systems: throw Computer/EDU 10+, modified by the ship's Sensor DM. If successful, a single gunner may choose to target a specific system on the enemy ship with one attack. If that gunner's next attack is successful and does damage, they may select which system the attack has hit.

Sensor Lock: throw Computer/INT 8+, modified by the ship's Sensor DM. As well, apply a negative DM equal to the target ship's Electronics DM (DM+0 and lower do not count). If successful, all attacks against the locked ship gain a DM+1. The sensor lock lasts until the ship attempts to lock onto another target, or it is broken by the target.

Break Sensor Lock: throw Computer/INT 10+, modified by the ship's Sensor DM. As well, apply a negative DM equal to the attacker's ship Electronics DM (DM+0 and lower do not count). If successful, the existing Sensor Lock is broken.

GUNNER ACTIONS

Each gunner may take one of the following actions. Note that a gunner in a turret may fire all the weapons in that turret using different actions, once per round. For example, a gunner in a turret with a Beam Laser, a Pulse Laser, and a Missile Rack may fire the Beam Laser, launch a missile, and engage in point defense with the Pulse laser.

Fire Energy Weapons: throw Gunnery/DEX 8+ to hit a target with an energy weapon such as a laser, particle beam, meson gun, or fusion gun in their turret. For bays and main guns, the Chief Gunner of each such weapon makes a Gunnery/INT 8+ throw to hit the target.

Launch Missiles or Torpedos: the gunner launches one missile per rack in the turret. Torpedo launchers fire one torpedo per launcher. Torpedo bays fire salvoes of 12 torpedoes. Throw Gunnery/INT 8+ before launch to lock the missiles on their target. Failure to lock prevents launching but keeps the missiles ready for launch in the future. If a Sensor Lock exists on the target (see Sensor Operator actions, above), no missile lock throw is required.

Missiles ignore Position modifiers to hit but are vulnerable to point-defense fire and electronic warfare spoofing. Missiles will hit their target at the end of the next round after their launch, allowing the targeting ship to attack missiles with point-defense and spoofing, if desired. On the round that the missiles reach their target, throw 4+ to hit the target, unmodified by any skill. The Evasive Maneuvers Pilot action affects this missile attack throw. So does any Sandcaster screen modifier that round. Smart missiles that miss the first round may retry this throw once in the following round, after which they are no longer viable.

Point Defense: any energy weapon can perform point defense fire against incoming missiles, though pulse lasers are the most effective for this task. Throw Gunnery/DEX 10+ to destroy an incoming missile, with DM+2 if using a pulse laser. The gunner may make multiple point defense attacks with the same turret weapon in the same action, but each attack after the first suffers from a cumulative DM-1, so the third shot, for example, will suffer DM-2 to hit the missile. Using this basic rule, throw against each incoming missile, but note that unlike regular attacks, here the gunner may try to gun down multiple missiles per combat round, with the penalty noted above. If a turret has multiple energy weapons in a turret being used for Point Defense, each weapon is rolled for separately – negative DMs for multiple attacks to not transfer between weapons. However, all weapons in a given turret must be used for point defense against missiles coming from the same enemy ship.

Launch Sand: the gunner may launch sand canisters to serve as a defensive screen. Throw Gunner/DEX 6+ to apply a DM-1 to all weapons and sensor locks from a single ship for one round. Multiple canisters stack their DM to a maximum of DM-3. Canisters last for one round, until the ship's next turn.

Note: each weapon in a double or triple turret has its own attack throw. However, energy weapons mounted in the same turret may only attack the same target. The gunner may launch missiles at any desired target. Fixed mount cannot serve to attack unless the vessel has Position or has successfully executed an Attack Vector maneuver. Each weapon within a given turret can only shoot once per combat round, except when used for point defense. A gunner may fire all or some of the weapons in the same turret at the same round. In a triple turret, a gunner can fire all three weapons every turn.

Finally, note that, for the sake of simplicity, a missile rack, or torpedo launcher or torpedo bay must fire all its missiles against a single target each round.

Optional Rule: Streamlined Point Defense for ships up to 999 tons

In large battles involving large numbers of missiles and lasers, attacking each missile individually by point defense fire is quite impractical. To simplify such combat, use the following rule. At the beginning of each round, the defender decides how many, if any, energy weapons are dedicated to point defense. This applies a negative DM to all incoming missiles' hit throws, per the following table. Sand Canisters also apply a DM-1 similar to laser point defense.

Optional Rule: Streamlined Turret Fire

To reduce the amount of die rolls in ship combat, we recommend that for ships with more than 3 turrets, each double or triple turret should carry the same type of weapons. This allows all weapons to share the same attack throw but attacking at DM+1 for a double turret or at DM+2 for a triple turret. Damage is for one weapon only—we abstract the other weapons' contributions as increasing the chances of scoring a hit. Under this optional rule, all weapons in such a turret must attack the same target. If launching missiles, all missiles in the same turret share a single locking throw but hit their target individually. We recommend that when using the streamlined turret fire rules, you should also use the streamlined point defense rules (see below) for the sake of simplicity.

Streamlined Point Defense – for ships up to 999 tons

Weapons	DM to incoming missiles
1	-1
2-4	-2
5-7	-3
8-9	-4

Optional Rule: Streamlined Point Defense for ships of 1000+ tons

To resolve streamlined point defense for ships of 1000-10000 tons, use the following table of laser turrets and sand canisters vs. missiles. The attacker makes a single attack throw, Gunnery/INT 8+, without modifiers; if successful, at least some of the missiles hit their target. Then consult the following table to find how many hits were caused by the missiles that penetrated the target's defensive laser fire. Results marked with a dash ("-") means that no hits are possible even with a successful attack throw. The left-most vertical column in the number of laser turrets; the top horizonal row is the number of inbound missiles.

The table assumed unarmored, 1000+ tons, starships, which are always rated at Light Armor. For ships rated at Heavy Armor (i.e., Lightly Armored large ships), consider the number of lasers being two steps better; nuclear weapons ignore this. Non-nuclear missiles are ineffective vs. Heavy Armor and nuclear missiles suffer from the number of lasers being two steps better. Both conventional and nuclear missiles are ineffective against Massive Armor.

Missile vs Laser Turret hits

Number of Laser turrets/ sand	10-20	21-30	31-40	41-50	51-60	61-80	81+
10-20	1D	2D	3D	1 Critical	1D Criticals	Destroyed!	Destroyed!
21-30	1D	2D	2D	3D	1 Critical	Destroyed!	Destroyed!
31-40	1	1D	1D	2D	3D	1 Critical	1D Criticals
41-50	-	1	1	1D	2D	3D	1 Critical
51-60	-	-	1	1	1D	2D	3D
61-80	-	-	-	1	1	1D	2D
81+	-	-	-	-	1	1	1D

ENGINEER ACTIONS

Any character with the Engineering skill can perform **Damage Control** – emergency repairs of damaged systems and breaches. Multiple characters with this skill may perform damage control at the same time, each on a different system. Throw Engineering/INT 8+ to repair a damaged system or to jury-rig a single disabled system back into operation. Success temporarily repairs one hit on the system. The damage will reappear in 1D hours. Note: destroyed systems cannot be repaired or jury-rigged during combat.

Characters without the Engineering skill but with the Repair skill may assist an engineer in damage control, using the Collaborati rules in the Basic Game Mechanics chapter.

Repair drones can make one damage control check per combat round.

Overcharge Weapon: the engineer can disable the safeties on an energy weapon for extra damage. Throw Engineering/EDU 8+ to boost a single energy turret's Hits rating by +1, including all energy weapons mounted on said turret.

Redline Engines: the ship's chief engineer throws Engineering/EDU 8+. On a success, the ship's thrust rating increases by 1 for next round (including the Position throw).

STARSHIP DAMAGE

When an attack hits a target, refer to the Ship Penetration Matrix Table below, then roll on the appropriate component damage table. Each weapon indicates (in its "hit" statistic) how many rolls to make on that table. Roll radiation damage separately on the Radiation Table. If a Gunner scores a particularly stunning hit with Effect 6+, shift one column to the left when reading damage. That is, if a gunner fired a beam laser and hit a target with Light Armor, it would normally do Surface damage. However, if that gunner rolled an Effect 6+, treat the target as Unarmored; the attack would do Internal damage.

Ship Penetration Matrix Table

Weapon/Armor	Unarmored	Light	Heavy	Massive
Light	Internal	Surface	Undamaged	Undamaged
Intermediate	Critical	Internal	Surface	Undamaged
Heavy	Destroyed	Critical	Internal	Surface
Main Gun	Destroyed	Destroyed	Critical	Internal



Surface Hits Table

2D	Surface Componets
2-6	No damage – attack bounces off
7-8	Breach
9-10	Weapon
11	Electronics
12	Internal Hit

Internal Hits Table

2D	Starship Components	Small Craft Components
2	Breach	Sensors
3	Power Plant	Power Plant
4	Jump Drive	Hold
5	Weapons	Maneuver Drive
6	Maneuver Drive	Crew
7	Breach	Maneuver Drive
8	Hold	Armor
9	Crew	Weapons
10	Sensors	Breach
11	Bridge	Cockpit
12	Critical	Critical

Radiation Hits Table

2D	Radiation Damage
2-5	No damage – radiation absorbed by hull
6-7	Sensors
8-9	Electronics
10-11	Crew
12	Critical

Note that the ship's armor modifies Radiation Hits, unlike other types of hits. Apply DM-1 for Light Armor, DM-2 for Heavy Armor, DM-4 for Massive Armor, and DM+1 per additional radiation hit in the same round.

Critical Hits Table

1D	Starship Critical Hit	Small Craft Critical Hit
1	Power Plant Destroyed	Maneuver Drive Destroyed
2	Maneuver Drive Destroyed	Maneuver Drive Destroyed
3	Jump Drive Destroyed	Power Plant Destroyed
4	Critical Crew Hit	Critical Crew Hit
5	Electronics Destroyed	Electronics Destroyed
6	Ship Destroyed	Ship Destroyed

SURFACE AND INTERNAL HIT DESCRIPTIONS

The following is a description of ship system internal hits. Note that if a system is destroyed, any more damage on the same system has no further effect.

Breach

The ship suffers a hull breach and is exposed to vacuum. Anyone not wearing a space suit or in a sealed compartment suffers exposure to vacuum per the Environmental Hazards chapter. Staterooms are considered sealed for the purposes of this damage. On large ships of above 1000 tons, each Breach depressurizes 1000 tons of the ship.

Bridge

The bridge is hit.

First Hit: the crew suffers a Crew Hit (see below). DM-2 on all future Position rolls.

Second Hit: bridge disabled; Captain, Pilot, and Sensor Operator actions are impossible until the bridge is repaired, and Gunnery throws suffer DM-2. The crew suffers a Crew Hit (see below).

Third Hit: bridge irreparably destroyed; each bridge crew member suffers 4D damage, reduced by personal armor.

Cockpit

The small craft's cockpit or control cabin is hit.

First Hit: the crew suffers a Crew Hit (see below). DM-2 on all future Position rolls.

Second Hit: cockpit disabled; all actions are impossible; The crew suffers a Crew Hit (see below).

Third Hit: cockpit irreparably destroyed, and each bridge crew member suffers 4D damage.

Crew

1D crew members and passengers suffer 2D damage each. If there are fewer people than the number rolled, one or more of them, randomly determined, will receive multiple hits. Personal armor reduces this damage.

Critical Crew Hit

All crew and passengers suffer 4D damage each. This damage can be reduced by personal armor.

Electronics

The electronic systems are hit.

First Hit: The electronics are scrambled. Until the system is repaired, the ship suffers a DM-2 to all Computer, Piloting, and Gunnery rolls.

Subsequent Hits: No effect.

Fuel

The jump fuel tank is hit.

First Hit: 1Dx5% of fuel tank capacity is destroyed.

Second Hit: 1Dx10% of the fuel tank capacity is destroyed. This fuel loss is in addition to the losses of the first hit.

Third Hit: Fuel tanks destroyed; all jump fuel is lost

Hold

The cargo hold is hit.

First Hit: 1Dx5% of the cargo is destroyed.

Second Hit: 1Dx10% of cargo is destroyed. This cargo loss is in addition to the losses of the first hit.

Third Hit: the cargo hold, and all its contents are destroyed.

Jump Drive

The ship's jump drive is hit.

First Hit: DM-2 to any attempt to jump.

Second Hit: jump drive disabled.

Third Hit: jump drive irreparably destroyed.

Maneuver Drive

The maneuver drive is hit.

First Hit: halve the ship's remaining thrust (round down).

Second Hit: maneuver drive disabled. The ship is adrift and has a Position of 0.

Third Hit: maneuver drive irreparably destroyed.

Power Plant

The power plant is hit.

First Hit: halve the ship's thrust and jump rating (round down).

Second Hit: power plant disabled. The ship is functioning on emergency power. Energy weapons fire is impossible. The ship can maneuver, but will always lose Position.

Third Hit: power plant irreparably destroyed. Emergency power remains for 1D hours; afterwards, life support systems will fail. Low berths are unaffected by this as they have an integral, long-term power supply.

Sensors

The ship's antennae and other sensor equipment are hit.

First Hit: ship sensor DM reduced by -1 (cumulative with electronics damage) Ship can no longer obtain Sensor Locks

Second Hit: ship sensor DM reduced by -2. Ship cannot make or break Sensor Locks and gunners suffer DM-2 to missile lock attempts.

Third Hit: Sensors disabled. Gunnery missile lock attempts suffer DM-6.

Weapons

Each hit disables one weapon in a given location:

Weapon Hit Table

2D	Location
2-9	Turret hit
10-11	Bay hit
12	Main gun hit

Randomly determine which turret, bay, or main gun is hit." Before "If there are no bays or main guns, disable turret weapons instead. If there are no bays or main guns, disable turret weapons instead.

Multiple hits on the same weapon (not just turret) destroy the weapon. Additional hits on a destroyed weapon are transferred to other randomly determined weapon systems

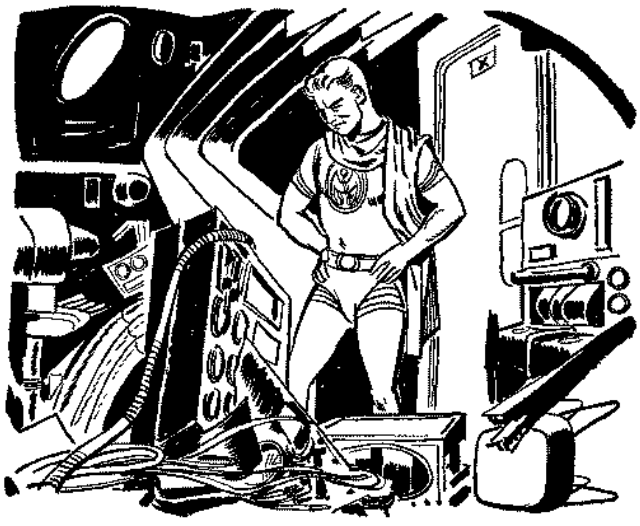
REPAIRING DAMAGE

Jury-rigged systems repaired using the **Damage Control** action will fail within 1D hours. After that, the system requires full repairs. Throw Engineering/EDU 8+ to fully repair a damaged system; this takes 1D hours and requires 0.02 tons of spare parts per ton of repaired system. A successful throw returns the system to operational status. A failed throw may be repeated but will require additional spare parts.

Spare parts cost Cr100,000 per ton, and may be stored in the ship's cargo bay.

Multiple engineers may work on repairs simultaneously, provided that each works on a different system. Alternately, multiple engineers may work on the same repair using the Collaboration rules.

Replacing a destroyed system requires a shipyard and costs 2Dx10% of the system's original cost



SPACE COMBAT EXAMPLE: A LITTLE BIT OF THE OL' PIRACY!

The Cast:

The Corsair *The Reaper*, Matitya Tarkwa, captain.

All crew skills are DM+3 (including characteristic bonuses) for simplicity's sake. However, the Pilot of the *Reaper* is an Ace, giving the ship advantage on Position rolls.

Corsair

Yarr! The pirate ship.

Corsair	**Tonnage**: 300	**Armor**: Light Crystaliron	Streamlined
Maneuver: 4 G	**Jump Rating**: 3	**P-Plant**: Rating 4	**Fuel**: 90 tons 1x Jump 3
Electronics: Model/3, DM+1	**Armament**: 3x triple turrets: 1x missile, 2x pulse lasers		
Fittings: 20 escape pods, armory for 10 marines, fuel processor (30t/day), 10 staterooms, 10 cryoberths, 5 emergency low berths, 57 tons of cargo space			
Crew: 19 total – captain, pilot, sensor operator, medic, 2x engineers, 3xx gunners, 10 ship's troops. All crew at double occupancy except for the captain.			
Cost: MCr157.4; **Construction Time**: 52 weeks			

The Freighter *Star of Progress*, Gwen Raleigh, captain.

All crew skills are DM+1 (including characteristic bonuses) for simplicity's sake.

Freighter

The pirates' prey.

Freighter	**Tonnage**: 600	**Armor**: None	Distributed
Maneuver: 1 G	**Jump Rating**: 2	**P-Plant**: Rating 2	**Fuel**: 120 tons 1x Jump 2
Electronics: Model/1bis, DM-2	**Armament**: 2x single turrets: 1 pulse laser, 1 sandcaster		
Fittings: gig, 4 escape pods, 4 staterooms, 388 tons cargo			
Crew: 4 total – pilot, sensor operator, 2x engineers.			
Cost: MCr163.7; **Construction Time**: 78 weeks			

The Patrol Frigate *Watchful*, Lt. Cmdr Yosef Khaleer, captain.

All crew skills are DM+3 (including characteristic bonuses) for simplicity's sake.

Frigate

The law.

Frigate	**Tonnage**: 400	**Armor**: Light Superdense	Standard
Maneuver: 4 G	**Jump Rating**: 3	**P-Plant**: Rating 4	**Fuel**: 120 tons 1x Jump 3
Electronics: Model/3, DM+1	**Armament**: 4x triple turrets: 2 large particle beams, 1x pulse lasers, 1x sandcasters		
Fittings: ship's boat, 24 escape pods, armory for 10 marines, fuel scoops, fuel processor (120t/day), 12 staterooms, 10 emergency low berths, repair drones, magazine for 48 sand canisters, 19.5 tons of cargo space			
Crew: 22 total – captain, 3 pilots, 3x sensor operator, medic, 2x engineers, 4x gunners, 8x marines. All crew at double occupancy except for the captain.			
Cost: Mcr231.1; **Construction Time**: 52 weeks			

The infamous pirate *Reaper* has fallen for the oldest trick in the book: being lured in by the *Star of Progress*, a fat, slow freighter with an escort frigate waiting to pounce! Fortunately for the *Reaper*, the pirate's sensor operator managed to spot the trap before *Reaper* moved in to board the *Star of Progress*. The Referee has ruled that the *Watchful* has to disable the *Reaper* in at most five rounds, or it will escape.

Round 1:

Position Rolls:

Reaper: 2D (advantage) + 3 (Crew skill) + 4 (Thrust) = 5 + 7 = 12

Watchful: 1D + 3 (Crew skill) + 4 (Thrust) = 5 + 7 = 12

Star of Progress: 1D + 1 (Crew skill) + 1 (Thrust) = 5 + 2 = 7

The *Reaper* and *Watchful* have Effect 0 on Position. They are able to attack each other. The Referee rules that since the *Watchful* was ambushing the *Reaper*, it will go first.

The *Watchful*:

The Captain attempts to Lead Crew, throwing Leadership/INT 8+: 4 + 3 (Crew skill) = 7, which does not help.

The Pilot will perform an Attack Vector action so that at least one of the large particle beam turrets will have a better shot: Piloting/DEX 8+: 5 + 3 (Crew skill) = 8, which is not sufficient to provide a bonus.

The Sensor Operator will attempt to lock onto the Reaper: Computer/INT 8 +: 4 + 3 (Crew skill) + 1 (Sensor DM) – 1 (Enemy Sensor DM) = 7. The Watchful is unable to gain a lock.

The Engineer will Redline Engines for next round's Position throw. Engineering/EDU 8+: 6 + 3 (Crew skill) = 9, a success, finally! The next round, the Watchful's thrust will be 5G.

The Gunners open fire:

Large Particle Beam 1: Gunnery/DEX 8+: 12 + 3 (Crew skill) – 2 (Position DM) = 13, a solid hit, with Effect 5!

Large Particle Beam 2: Gunnery/DEX 8+: 6 + 3 (Crew Skill) – 2 (Position DM) = 7, a miss.

Pulse Laser Turret:

Laser 1: Gunnery/DEX 8+: 3 + 3 (Crew Skill) – 2 (Position DM) – 2 (Pulse) = 2, a miss.

Laser 2: Gunnery/DEX 8+: 11 + 3 (Crew Skill) – 2 (Position DM) – 2 (Pulse) = 10, a hit.

Laser 3: Gunnery/DEX 8+: 5 + 3 (Crew Skill) – 2 (Position DM) – 2 (Pulse) = 4, a miss.

Sancaster Turret: launch sand to screen the Watchful.

Caster 1: Gunnery/DEX 6+: 9 + 3 (Crew skill) – 2 (Position DM) = 10, a success.

Caster 2: Gunnery/DEX 6+: 9 + 3 (Crew skill) – 2 (Position DM) = 10, a success.

Caster 3: Gunnery/DEX 6+: 4 + 3 (Crew skill) – 2 (Position DM) = 5, a failure.

The *Reaper's* lasers will have a DM-2 to hit the *Watchful*.

The large particle beam is an intermediate weapon. Against the Reaper's light armor, it causes two Internal hits and a radiation attack: 6, M-drive. The Reaper's thrust is halved to 2G; 8, Hold. 10% of the Reaper's cargo has been destroyed. The radiation attack result is a 2: no damage.

The *Reaper* now gets to act.

The Captain decides to Lead Crew, throwing Leadership/INT8+: 9 + 3 (Crew skill) = 12, for an Effect of 4. This gives a total of positive DMs of 4 for the captain to distribute as he sees fit. He thinks he will need it.

The Engineer will attempt to repair the Maneuver drive using Damage Control, Engineering/INT 8+, with the captain's DM+1 support: 6 + 3 (Crew skill) + 1 (Captain bonus) = 10. The Maneuver Drive is back to 4G! The Referee notes that this repair will fail in 1D hours.

Because the Engineer was successful, the Captain decides he does not need to give any support to the helm. The Pilot will attempt Evasive Maneuvers, rolling Piloting/DEX 12+: 5 + 3 (Crew Skill) + 4 (Available Thrust!) = 12, which succeeds! The Reaper will penalize attacks against it by DM-2 (assume the Pilot's skill is 2, with a DM+1 from a characteristic bonus). This DM will last until the *Reaper's* next turn.

The Sensor Operator will attempt a Sensor Lock on the *Watchful*. The Captain will provide a DM+1 bonus to ensure this works. Computers/INT 8+: 5 + 3 (Crew skill) + 1 (Sensor DM) – 1 (Sensor DM of enemy ship) + 1 (Captain's support) = 9, which succeeds. The gunners will each have a DM+1 to hit the Watchful.

The *Reaper's* Gunners will fire all turrets:

Missile Triple Turret: consists of three missile racks, which means that the Gunner must lock on to the *Watchful* with Gunnery/INT 8+. However, since the Reaper has a sensor lock on target, the missiles can fire automatically. These are all normal missiles. They will hit at the end of next turn after the *Watchful* has a chance to shoot them down or spoof them.

Pulse Laser Turret 1: the captain supports the first two Gunnery rolls with a DM+1 to hit for each.

Pulse Laser 1: Gunnery/DEX 8+: 7 + 3 (Gunnery Skill) + 1 (Support) – 2 (Position DM) – 2 (Pulse Laser) + 1 (Sensor Lock) – 2 (Sand penalty) = 6, a miss.

Pulse Laser 2: Gunnery/DEX 8+: 2 + 3 (Gunnery Skill) + 1 (Support) – 2 (Position DM) – 2 (Pulse Laser) + 1 (Sensor Lock) – 2 (Sand penalty) = 1, a miss.

Pulse Laser 3: Gunery/DEX 8+: 10 + 3 (Gunnery Skill) - 2 (Position DM) - 2 (Pulse laser) + 1 (Sensor Lock) - 2 (Sand Penalty) = 8, a hit!

Pulse Laser Turret 2: the Gunners fire, and each get a DM+1 from the target lock.

Pulse Laser 4: Gunnery/DEX 8+: 10 + 3 (Gunnery Skill) – 2 (Position DM) – 2 (Pulse Laser) + 1 (Sensor Lock) – 2 (Sand penalty) = 8, a hit!

Pulse Laser 5: Gunnery/DEX 8+: 10 + 3 (Gunnery Skill) – 2 (Position DM) – 2 (Pulse Laser) + 1 (Sensor Lock) – 2 (Sand penalty) = 8, a hit!

Pulse Laser 6: Gunnery/DEX 8+: 12 + 3 (Gunnery Skill) – 2 (Position DM) – 2 (Pulse Laser) + 1 (Sensor Lock) – 2 (Sand penalty) = 10, a hit! If they survive this encounter, this gunner is getting a promotion.

None of the 4 Pulse Laser hits had Effect 6+. Each one is a Light Weapon against Light Armor doing 2 hits. After consulting the Ship Penetration Matrix, that's six rolls on the Surface Hits table: a 2, three 7's, an 8, and two 9's. That's one scratch, four breaches and two Weapon hits. The three breaches are inconsequential for the *Watchful*, though might make for good roleplaying opportunities on a ship crewed by the player characters.

To determine which of the *Watchful's* weapons is disabled, consult the table under the Weapon damage effect: the result of 8 means a turret, and the Referee rolls randomly to determine which turret: 1: Sandcaster, 2: Pulse Laser, 3 & 4: Particle cannon, 5 & 6: Roll again. The result is 4! The Watchful has had one of its main guns disabled! The other weapon hits turret 2, which disables a single Pulse Laser.

The *Star of Progress* does not have Position on the Reaper, and is turning to disengage. The Pilots roll opposed Pilot/DEX:

Star of Progress: 4 + 1 (Crew skill) + 1 (Thrust) = 6

Reaper: 4 + 3 (Crew skill) + 4 (Thrust) = 11

The *Reaper* blocks the *Star of Progress* from disengaging.

Round 2:

Position Rolls:

Reaper: 2D (advantage) + 3 (Crew skill) + 4 (Thrust) = 5 + 7 = 12

Watchful: 1D + 3 (Crew skill) + 5 (Thrust modified from last round) = 1 + 7 = 6

Star of Progress: 1D + 1 (Crew skill) + 1 (Thrust) = 1 + 2 = 3

The *Reaper* has 6 points of Position on the *Watchful*, giving it a DM+1 to hit the frigate this round!

Captain Tarkwa manages to maneuver the *Reaper* into a perfect firing position on the *Watchful*. He pats the pilot on the shoulder, high praise from the bloodthirsty cutthroat!

The Captain Leads Crew and presses the attack! He throws Leadership/INT8+: 7 + 3 (Crew skill) = 10, for an Effect of 2. This gives a total of positive DMs of 2 for crew use later.

The Engineer will attempt to Overcharge Weapon, focusing on the first Pulse Laser triple turret. Engineering/EDU 8+: 5 + 3 (Crew skill) = 8. The first Pulse Laser Turret will have a DM+1 to hit for all three lasers.

Because the Engineer was successful in restoring the Maneuver drive, the Captain decides he does not need to give any support to the helm. The Evasive Maneuvers are finished, so the Pilot puts the ship on an optimal Attack Vector: Pilot/DEX 8+: 7 + 3 (Crew skill) = 10, which is an Effect of 2, meaning that either one Pulse Laser will have a DM+2 to hit, or two will have DM+1 to hit.

Since last round's Sensor Lock is still active, the Sensor Operator attempts a Target Systems action on the Watchful, aiming for the ship's weapons. Computers/EDU 10+: 11 + 3 (Crew skill) + 1 (Sensor DM) = 15, which succeeds. One of the Pulse Lasers will be able to target the Weapons systems.

The Gunners fire all turrets:

Missile Triple Turret: the gunners already have a lock, so they fire another salvo of three missiles. They will hit at the end of next turn.

Pulse Laser Turret 1: The captain supports the Gunnery roll of the single Pulse Laser that is targeting the *Watchful's* weapon systems with DM+2. The Pilot will give DM+2 to that pulse laser as well. All of the turret's guns gain a DM+1 for having such an advantageous Position over the *Watchful*, a DM+1 for Sensor Lock, and a DM+1 for the Engineer's Weapon Overcharge.

Pulse Laser 1: Gunnery/DEX 8+, targeting the Weapons system: 8 + 3 (Gunnery Skill) + 2 (Support) + 1 (Position DM) – 2 (Pulse Laser) + 1 (Sensor Lock) – 2 (Sand penalty) + 2 (Attack Vector) + 1 (Overcharge) = 14, a hit with Effect 6!

Pulse Laser 2: Gunnery/DEX 8+: 3 + 3 (Gunnery Skill) + 1 (Position DM) – 2 (Pulse Laser) + 1 (Sensor Lock) – 2 (Sand penalty) + 1 (Overcharge) = 5, a miss.

Pulse Laser 3: Gunnery/DEX 8+: 9 + 3 (Gunnery Skill) + 1 (Position DM) – 2 (Pulse Laser) + 1 (Sensor Lock) – 2 (Sand penalty) + 1 (Overcharge) = 11, a hit!

Pulse Laser Turret 2: each weapon gets a DM+1 from the Sensor Lock, and Position.

Pulse Laser 4: Gunnery/DEX 8+: 5 + 3 (Gunnery Skill) + 1 (Position DM) – 2 (Pulse Laser) + 1 (Sensor Lock) – 2 (Sand penalty) = 6, a miss.

Pulse Laser 5: Gunnery/DEX 8+: 3 + 11 (Gunnery Skill) + 1 (Position DM) – 2 (Pulse Laser) + 1 (Sensor Lock) – 2 (Sand penalty) = 9, a hit.

Pulse Laser 6: Gunnery/DEX 8+: 3 + 4 (Gunnery Skill) + 1 (Position DM) – 2 (Pulse Laser) + 1 (Sensor Lock) – 2 (Sand penalty) = 5, a miss.

The Pulse Laser that hit the Weapon Systems would normally do Surface damage against a Lightly armored vessel. However, because the Effect is 6+, we shift left one column on the Ship Penetration Matrix Table, and see that the damage is Internal. The Pulse Laser automatically hits the Weapon Systems, and the Referee rolls to determine which turret on the Watchful has been hit: 1: Sandcaster, 2: Pulse Laser, 3 & 4: Particle cannon, 5 & 6: Roll again. 4, which means that the Large particle cannon that was hit last turn is now destroyed. This is less than ideal, as it still leaves one particle cannon.

The other two Pulse Lasers each score 2 hits on the Surface Hits table for 5, 6, 4, and 6, which all score the armor, but do not penetrate the Watchful's hull.

Now, it's the *Watchful's* turn.

The Captain is going to Lead Crew because they will need the extra leadership! Leadership/INT8+: 3 + 3 (Crew skill) = 6, for no bonuses at all! This round just went from bad to worse.

The Pilot attempts Evasive Maneuvers, mainly because there are three missiles inbound this round, and next, and maybe it will help. Piloting/DEX 12+: 6 + 3 (Crew Skill) + 4 (Available Thrust!) = 13, which penalizes attacks on the Watchful by the pilot's skill of 2 (assume Pilot 2 and DEX 1 for this example), for DM-2.

The Engineer will attempt Damage Control on the Pulse Laser disabled in the first round. With three missiles coming in, all pulse lasers are going to be very useful for Point Defense, and the Large plasma cannon is damaged beyond repair. Engineering/INT 8+: 7 + 3 (Crew skill) = 10, the Pulse Laser is repaired! The Referee notes that it will fail in 1D hours.

It is time for the Sensor Operator to Spoof Missiles! They may spoof as many missiles as levels in Computer (2), at Computer/INT 8+: 7 + 3 (Crew skill) = 10. That's one missile jammed. The second Computer/INT 8+ throw is: 5 + 3 (Crew skill) 8. A second missile is spoofed. One more remains.

The Gunners now return fire. They are at DM-3 for their bad Position, but they can fire turrets. They suffer no other penalties.

Large Particle Beam 1: Destroyed!

Large Particle Beam 2: Gunnery/DEX 8+: 11 + 3 (Crew Skill) – 3 (Position DM) = 11, a solid hit!

Pulse Laser Turret: all the weapons in a turret must be devoted to Point Defense. Since they are Pulse Lasers, they gain a DM+2 to hit incoming missiles, but each missile after the first is attacked at a cumulative DM-1.

Laser 1: Gunnery/DEX 10+: 5 + 3 (Crew Skill) + 2 (Pulse) = 10, one missile is destroyed. One remains.

Laser 2: Gunnery/DEX 10+: 12 + 3 (Crew Skill) + 2 (Pulse) – 1 (first additional missile) = 15, the second missile is destroyed!

Laser 3: Gunnery/DEX 10+: all missiles destroyed this weapon fires pulses into space.

Sancaster Turret: Launches Sand to screen the *Watchful*.

Caster 1: Gunnery/DEX 6+: 6 + 3 (Crew skill) – 3 (Position DM) = 6, a success.

Caster 2: Gunnery/DEX 6+: 5 + 3 (Crew skill) – 3 (Position DM) = 5, a failure.

Caster 3: Gunnery/DEX 6+: 3 + 3 (Crew skill) – 3 (Position DM) = 3, a failure.

The *Reaper's* lasers will have a DM-1 to hit the *Watchful* until the latter ship's next turn.

The large particle beam is an intermediate weapon. Against the Reaper's light armor, it causes two Internal hits and a radiation attack: 6, and 5: one M-drive hit, and one weapon hit! The Reaper's thrust is halved to 2G; The Referee randomly determines that the Missile Turret is hit, and one missile rack has been disabled.

The *Star of Progress* now acts, and attempts to disengage throwing opposed Pilot/DEX:

Star of Progress: 3 + 1 (Crew skill) + 1 (Thrust) = 5

Reaper: 10 + 3 (Crew skill) + 2 (Thrust) = 15

There is still no escape for the *Star of Progress*!

Round 3:

Position Rolls:

Reaper: 2D (advantage) + 3 (Crew skill) + 2 (Thrust) = 5 + 5 = 10

Watchful: 1D + 3 (Crew skill) + 4 (Thrust) = 1 + 7 = 6

Star of Progress: 1D + 1 (Crew skill) + 1 (Thrust) = 3 + 2 = 5

Despite the damaged drive, the *Reaper's* superior maneuvering wins out! Captain Tarkwa has tasted blood, and he wants to send a message to whoever planned this trap. Since the Reaper's Position is four points higher than the Watchful's, it attacks at DM+0 to hit.

The Captain Leads Crew, and throws Leadership/INT 8+: 12 + 3 (Crew skill) = 15, for an impressive Effect of 7. This gives a total of positive DMs of 7 for crew use later!

The Engineer wants to repair the Maneuver drive using Damage Control, but the captain stops him: he wants another Weapon Overcharge on the first pulse laser turret! Engineering/EDU 8+, with the captain's DM+1 support: 9 + 3 (Crew skill) + 1 (Captain bonus) = 13. The three guns of the turret each get a DM+1 to hit.

The Pilot was going to protest, but thinks better of it. Instead, he performs Evasive Maneuvers while bringing the *Reaper* in for another pass. The Captain encourages him with a DM+2 (leaving DM+4 left to distribute). Pilot/DEX 12+: 5 + 3 (Crew skill) + 2 (Captain's support) + 2 (Thrust) = 12, which is just enough for the evasive action to be effective. The Watchful will suffer an additional DM-2 penalty on attacks against the Reaper.

The Sensor Lock is still active. The Sensor Operator attempts another Target Systems action on the *Watchful*, aiming for the ship's M-drive. Computers/EDU 10+: 8 + 3 (Crew skill) + 1 (Sensor DM) = 12, which succeeds. One of the Pulse Lasers (from the first pulse laser turret) will be able to target the Weapons systems.

The Gunners fire all turrets:

Missile Triple Turret: the gunners already have a lock, so they fire another salvo. One of the racks has been disabled, so only two missiles launch. They will hit at the end of next turn.

Pulse Laser Turret 1: The captain supports the Gunnery roll of the single Pulse Laser that is targeting the *Watchful's* M-drive with DM+4. All of the turret's guns gain a DM+1 for Sensor Lock, and a DM+1 for the Engineer's Weapon Overcharge. There is a DM-1 Sandcaster penalty from the *Watchful*, and the *Watchful* is performing Evasive Maneuvers (DM-2).

Pulse Laser 1: Gunnery/DEX 8+, targeting the M-drive: 7 + 3 (Gunnery Skill) + 4 (Support) + 1 (Sensor Lock) + 1 (Weapon Overcharge) – 1 (Sand penalty) – 2 (Evasive penalty) – 2 (Pulse Laser) = 11, a solid hit with effect 3.

Pulse Laser 2: Gunnery/DEX 8+: 8 + 3 (Gunnery Skill) + 1 (Sensor Lock) + 1 (Weapon Overcharge) – 1 (Sand penalty) – 2 (Evasive penalty) – 2 (Pulse Laser) = 8, a hit.

Pulse Laser 3: Gunnery/DEX 8+: 10 + 3 (Gunnery Skill) + 1 (Sensor Lock) + 1 (Weapon Overcharge) – 1 (Sand penalty) – 2 (Evasive penalty) – 2 (Pulse Laser) = 10, a hit.

Pulse Laser Turret 2: each weapon gets a DM+1 from the Sensor Lock. There is a DM-1 Sandcaster penalty from the Watchful, and the Watchful is performing Evasive Maneuvers (DM-2).

Pulse Laser 4: Gunnery/DEX 8+: 7 + 3 (Gunnery Skill) + 1 (Sensor Lock) – 1 (Sand penalty) – 2 (Evasive penalty) – 2 (Pulse Laser) = 6, a miss.

Pulse Laser 5: Gunnery/DEX 8+: 8 + 3 (Gunnery Skill) + 1 (Sensor Lock) – 1 (Sand penalty) – 2 (Evasive penalty) – 2 (Pulse Laser) = 7, miss.

Pulse Laser 6: Gunnery/DEX 8+: 8 + 3 (Gunnery Skill) + 1 (Sensor Lock) – 1 (Sand penalty) – 2 (Evasive penalty) – 2 (Pulse Laser) = 7, miss.

Checking the Ship Penetration Matrix Table, these light weapons are attacking light armor. This means that since the Pulse Laser that was targeting the Maneuver drive did not score a solid Effect 6+ hit, it cannot hit the M-drive, and is ineffective against the armor plate around the M-drive. The other two Pulse laser hits do a total of 4 surface damage rolls, 10, 9, and two 3's: the 10 is a Weapon hit, so the Referee randomly determines that the Sandcaster turret was hit, and one of the Sandcasters has been disabled. The 9 is also a Weapon hit, and the Referee determines that the blast hit the Sandcaster turret again, knocking out another Sandcaster.

The *Watchful* acts:

Shaking off the shock of being outmaneuvered by pirates, the Captain is going to Lead Crew because they will need the extra leadership! Leadership/INT8+: 8 + 3 (Crew skill) = 11, for a DM+3 total to distribute to other stations.

The Pilot again attempts Evasive Maneuvers, because another volley of three missiles are inbound at the end of the round! Piloting/DEX 12+: 3 + 3 (Crew Skill) + 4 (Available Thrust!) = 10, which provides no penalty to enemy fire!

The Engineer will attempt Damage Control on a Sandcaster, to help screen the ship!. Engineering/INT 8+: 9 + 3 (Crew skill) = 12, and the Engineer manages to return one of the sandcasters to functionality for 1D hours.

The Sensor Operator will Spoof Missiles again. They may spoof two missiles at Computer/INT 8+: 3 + 3 (Crew skill) = 6, a failure. That's one missile jammed. The second Computer/INT 8+ throw is: 6 + 3 (Crew skill) 9. One missile is fooled, and two remain on course.

The *Watchful's* Gunners open fire. They are at DM-3 for their bad Position, but they can fire turrets. They suffer DM-2 for the *Reaper's* Evasive Maneuvers.

Large Particle Beam 1: Destroyed!

Large Particle Beam 2: Gunnery/DEX 8+: 8 + 3 (Crew Skill) – 3 (Position DM) – 2 (Evasive) = 6, a miss.

Pulse Laser Turret: all the weapons in a turret are devoted to Point Defense. Since they are Pulse Lasers, they gain a DM+2 to hit incoming missiles, but each missile after the first is attacked at a cumulative DM-1.

Laser 1: Gunnery/DEX 10+: 3 + 3 (Crew Skill) + 2 (Pulse) = 8, a miss. Two missiles remain.

Laser 2: Gunnery/DEX 10+: 7 + 3 (Crew Skill) + 2 (Pulse) = 12, one missile destroyed.

Laser 3: Gunnery/DEX 10+: 5 + 3 (Crew skill) + 2 (pulse) – 1 (additional missile) = 9 miss! One missile remains to attack!

Sancaster Turret: Launches Sand to screen the *Watchful*.

Caster 1: Gunnery/DEX 6+: 6 + 3 (Crew skill) – 3 (Position DM) = 6, a success.

Caster 2: Gunnery/DEX 6+: 9 + 3 (Crew skill) – 3 (Position DM) = 9, a success.

Caster 3: Disabled

The *Reaper's* lasers will have a DM-2 to hit the *Watchful*.

The Star of Progress acts, and attempts to disengage throwing opposed Pilot/DEX:

Star of Progress: 5 + 1 (Crew skill) + 1 (Thrust) = 7

Reaper: 7 + 3 (Crew skill) + 2 (Thrust) = 12

There is still no escape for the S*tar of Progress*!

Finally, the missile that got through the Watchful's defenses attacks at 4+, with a new DM-2 Sancaster penalty: 6 – 2 = 4, a hit!

The missile is a light weapon and does 1D hits: 6! The rolls on the Surface damage table are: 9, 9, 3, 6, 8, 11. Two hits do no damage, two hit Weapons, one causes a breach, and one hits Electronics!

The Electronics hit penalizes all Computer, Piloting, and Gunnery throws on the *Watchful* by DM-2.

The two weapons that are hit are: a Pulse Laser and a Sandcaster are both disabled.

The breach likely sucks crew out into space.

Round 4:

Position Rolls:

Reaper: 2D (advantage) + 3 (Crew skill) + 2 (Thrust) = 6 + 5 = 11

Watchful: 1D + 3 (Crew skill) + 4 (Thrust) = 3 + 7 = 10

Star of Progress: 1D + 1 (Crew skill) + 1 (Thrust) = 1 + 2 = 3

Captain Tarkwa is concerned. Despite all the damage he has managed to inflict on the *Watchful*, he hasn't crippled it. And it is recovering. He orders the Pilot to disengage, and rolls to Lead Crew to support the effort: Leadership/INT 8+: 9 + 3 (Crew skill) = 12, an Effect of 4.

The Pilot breathes out a sigh of relief, and moves to Disengage, which is an opposed throw.

Reaper (with Advantage for having Position): 7 + 3 (Crew skill) + 2 (Thrust) + 4 (Captain's support) = 16

Watchful: 7 + 3 (Crew skill) + 4 (Thrust) = 14.

The *Reaper* successfully extricates itself from the trap, and quickly plots a jump to a safer system. ***Captain Tarkwa will have his revenge!***